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China Coal | Asia Pacific

Weekly Coal Update: Thermal Coal Prices Rebounded on Better Demand Outlook Driven by Summer Heats

Key Takeaways

- Thermal coal prices grew WoW, while coking coal prices trended down.

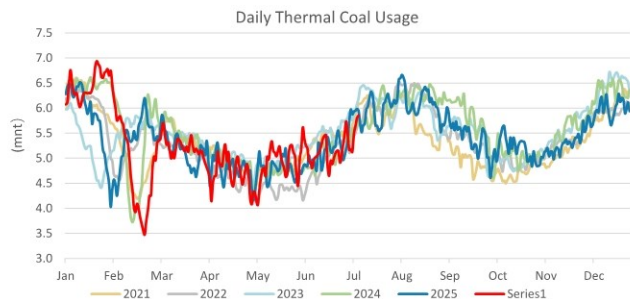
Thermal coal prices hiked: QHD 5500 inched up 0.1% WoW to Rmb722/t as of July 17. BSPI edged down 0.1% WoW to Rmb713/t. CCI 5500 hiked 2.6% WoW to Rmb821/t. Mine-mouth prices for Shanxi Datong 5800 rose 3.7% WoW to Rmb708/t.

Seaborne prices unchanged: NEWC prices were flat WoW.

Domestic coking coal prices trended down: Liulin No. 4 mine-mouth prices declined 1.7% WoW to Rmb850/t. FOR prices were flattish WoW at Rmb2,010/t. QLD prices dropped 2.1% WoW to US\$233/t.

Chart of the week – Thermal coal prices rebounded on better demand outlook driven by summer heat: China's domestic thermal coal market rebounded in the week ended July 17, with prices advancing across both production areas and northern ports. A widening cost inversion on shipments to port and continued output curbs at production areas under safety inspection lent further support to prices. Expanding high-temperature weather fronts accelerated the rise in thermal generation, with regions such as East China beginning to see modest restocking demand from both utilities and non-power industrial users, including metallurgical and chemical plants, according to Sxcoal.

Exhibit 1: Chart of the Week – Daily Thermal Coal Usage at 25 Provinces



Source: Sxcoal, Morgan Stanley Research.

MORGAN STANLEY ASIA LIMITED+

Hannah Yang, CFA

Equity Analyst

Hannah.Yang1@morganstanley.com

+852 2239-7079

Cynthia Tang

Research Associate

Cynthia.Tang@morganstanley.com

+852 3963-4360

Rachel L Zhang

Equity Analyst

Rachel.Zhang@morganstanley.com

+852 2239-1520

Chris Jiang

Equity Analyst

Chris.Jiang@morganstanley.com

+852 3963-1593



CHINA COAL

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Industry View

Cautious

Exhibit 2 : Data for the week

		17-Jul	WoW	YTD	YTD avg	'25 avg	YTD vs '25
Regional							
NEWC thermal coal	US\$/ton	130	0.0%	19.3%	128	106.6	20.2%
QLD coking coal	US\$/ton	233	-2.1%	6.9%	234	189.0	23.9%
China							
QHD 5500 kcal/kg	Rmb/ton	722	0.1%	3.9%	704	684	2.9%
CCI 5500 kcal/kg	Rmb/ton	821	2.6%	20.4%	775	864	-10.3%
BSPI	Rmb/ton	713	-0.1%	2.6%	697	682	2.2%
Liulin No. 4 mine-mouth	Rmb/ton	850	-1.7%	26.9%	731	641	13.9%
Liulin No. 4 FOR	Rmb/ton	2,010	0.0%	27.2%	1,683	1,399	20.3%
QHD Inventory	mt	6.80	0.0%	-2.4%	6.23	6.37	-2.2%

Note: QLD = Queensland; QHD = Qinhuangdao; CCI = China Coal Index; BSPI = Bohai-Rim Steam-Coal Price Index; FOR = Free on Rail. Source: China Coal Transport and Distribution Association (CCTD), McCloskeys, Morgan Stanley Research.

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Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	1	0%	33%	1	0%
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Hannah Yang, CFA		
China Coal Energy Co., Ltd. (601898.SS)	E (03/16/2026)	Rmb13.79
China Coal Energy Co., Ltd. (1898.HK)	O (03/16/2026)	HK\$10.80
China Shenhua Energy (1088.HK)	O (11/02/2017)	HK\$43.60
China Shenhua Energy (601088.SS)	E (04/04/2019)	Rmb46.14
Shaanxi Coal Industry (601225.SS)	O (03/16/2026)	Rmb25.00
Shanxi Coking Coal (000983.SZ)	E (10/26/2021)	Rmb6.29
Yancoal Australia Ltd (3668.HK)	O (03/16/2026)	HK\$30.86
Yankuang Energy Group Co Ltd (1171.HK)	O (03/16/2026)	HK\$11.84
Yankuang Energy Group Co Ltd (600188.SS)	E (03/16/2026)	Rmb20.79
Rachel L Zhang		
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